

INDIA@PARIS 2024

INDIA'S SHUTTLE DUOPOLY

CHIRAG SHETTY, 27
& SATWIKSAIRAJ RANKIREDDY, 23

Sport: ***BADMINTON MEN'S DOUBLES***

Achievements: **Gold at Asian Games, bronze at 2022 World Championships, part of the Thomas Cup-winning squad of 2022**

How they qualified: **On Badminton World Federation (BWF) rankings**

Photographs by BANDEEP SINGH

Satwik bares it all," teases Chirag Shetty as his younger partner Satwiksairaj Rankireddy reluctantly removes his T-shirt at the request of the photographer. For Chirag, the act is a trademark move now, it's how he celebrates most tournament wins. Satwik prefers a spontaneous jig, often with racket in tow. In a discipline not known for its exuberance—2016 Olympic champion Carolina Marin being a noisy exception—SatChi, as they have been christened by fans, are proudly so. Chirag's the chatty city slicker, Mumbai *cha mulga*; Satwik's the shy guy from Amalapuram in Andhra Pradesh who moved to Hyderabad in his early teens. Put them on the court and they are, as the '90s pop hit goes, 'MFEO' (Made for each other).